

Cem Emrence

University of Michigan

Department of Political Science

Political scientist studying violence and rhetoric using computational methods and causal inference

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate, University of Michigan, Department of Political Science

Expected May 2027

- Fields of Study: World Politics, Quantitative Methodology
- Dissertation Title: *The Language of Non-Institutional Politics and Power*. Co-chairs: Mark Dincecco and Yuri Zhukov

M.A. in Modern Turkish History, Boğaziçi University

B.A. in Sociology, Boğaziçi University

RESEARCH

Books

- A. Aydin and C. Emrence, *Zones of Rebellion: Kurdish Insurgents and the Turkish State*. Ithaca, NY: Cornell University Press, 2015.

Reviewed in *Perspectives on Politics, Journal of Politics, Small Wars & Insurgencies, Military Review, Nationalities Papers, International Affairs, H-Net Reviews, Choice, International Journal of Turkish Studies*, and *Hurriyet Daily News*.

Journal Articles

- A. Aydin and C. Emrence, "Counterinsurgency as an Institution: Evidence from Turkey," *International Interactions*, vol. 47, 2021. **Best Paper Award** (2021).
- C. Emrence and A. Aydin, "Killing the Movement: How Islam Became a Rival of Ethnic Movement in Turkey, 1991–2002," *Research in Social Movements, Conflicts and Change*, vol. 41, 2017.

Job Market Paper

- C. Emrence, "The Language of Non-Institutional Politics and Power."
Uses NLP on a one-million-page multilingual corpus to show that political outsiders use action-oriented rhetoric for survival and that power shapes its intensity.

Under Review

- C. Emrence, "Ideology and Violence in Civil War."

Work in Progress

- C. Emrence, "Keeping Them Out: Emotive Rhetoric of Institutional Insiders."

In Preparation

- C. Emrence, "One Foot In, One Foot Out: The Rhetorical Transformation of U.S. Women's, Labor and Civil Rights Movements."
- C. Emrence, "From Outsider to Insider: The Rhetoric of Insurgent-Turned-Government Groups."

METHODS TRAINING

Course	Provider	
Text-as-Data & Programming		2019–2023
Collecting, Classifying and Analyzing Textual Data Using R	ICPSR	
Machine Learning: Applications in Social Science Research	ICPSR	
Data Science and Text Analysis	ICPSR	
Data Visualization	ICPSR	
Social Science Computer Usage	Political Science Department	
An Introduction to R Computing Environment	ICPSR	
Statistics & Causal Inference		2019–2021
Causal Inference I	Political Science Department	
Causal Inference	Oxford Spring School	
Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis	School of Information	
Statistical Methods in Political Science Research I	Political Science Department	
Statistical Methods in Political Science Research II	Political Science Department	

Additional Methods

Introduction to Geographic Information Systems
Spatial Data Analysis
Network Theory
Intermediate Game Theory
Mathematics for Political Science

Urban Planning Department
Sociology Department
ICPSR
Political Science Department
Political Science Department

2019–2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Course	Level	Role	
Text-as-Data & Programming			2024–2025
Social Science Computer Usage	Grad	Instructor of Record	
Text as Data for Social Science	Grad	Graduate Student Instructor (GSI)	
Statistics & Causal Inference			2022–2023
Quantitative Methods in Social Science	UG	GSI	
Statistical Methods in Political Science II	Grad	Grader	
Causal Inference II	Grad	Grader	
Bayesian Inference for the Social Sciences	Grad	Grader	
World Politics			2020, 2023
Introduction to World Politics	UG	GSI	
State Repression and Human Rights	UG	GSI	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and software: R, Stata, ArcGIS, cURL, LaTeX.

Text-as-Data, NLP, and Machine Learning Tools: OCR, web scraping, POS tagging, dependency parsing, topic modeling, word embeddings, transformer models, dictionary methods, cross-validation.

Statistics and Causal Inference: synthetic control, difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, matching, directed acyclic graphs, bootstrapping.

Additional Methods: spatial statistics, Moran's I, k-means clustering, graph theory applications.

ORIGINAL DATA COLLECTION

- Collected original data on insurgency, counterinsurgency, revolutionary groups, far-right groups, protest, elections, and socio-economic indicators.
- Built a large-scale text corpus of ≈ 1 M pages with ≈ 750 M tokens.
- Compiled structured data covering $\approx 10,000$ events, 14 elections, and 150 variables.

FUNDING

Awards and Grants

- Weiser Center for Emerging Democracies Award (\$18,000)
- ISR-Rackham Training Award for ICPSR
- Summer Collaboration Grant, Political Science (\$12,000)
- Department of Political Science, DGS Research Grant

2019–2022

Fellowships and Scholarships

- Rackham One-Term Dissertation Fellowship
- Department of Political Science One-Term Fellowship
- Tuition and Scholarship, Department of Political Science

2019–2026

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND SERVICE

- “Power and Language.” American Political Science Association (APSA), 2026 (scheduled).
- “Finding Allied Communities in Civil Wars,” with Aysegul Aydin. American Political Science Association (APSA), 2020.
- **Ad hoc reviewer:** *Journal of Peace Research* (JPR); *International Studies Quarterly* (ISQ).

REFERENCES

Mark Dincecco

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